

NTL20 Enrichment

8→ **1. Spikenard, Bible Dictionary:** “The Greek word denotes pistis nard, pistis being perhaps a local name; some take it to mean genuine; others, liquid. Nard was made from the root of a tree, with a strong aromatic odor.”

†**2. The Triumphal Entry:** “All Jerusalem was in an uproar. It was the season of the Passover, and everywhere in the city travelers arrived, lambs and pigeons for offerings were sold, and sacrificial coins clattered in the coffers of those who had perverted the stewardship of caring for Israel. Above the festive clamor for religious merchandise, Jerusalem reverberated with concern about the “Prophet of Galilee.” Among the common people and on the lips of staunch Pharisees was ever the same question: “What think ye, that he will not come to the feast [of the Passover]?” ([John 11:56](#).)” ([The Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles](#), see the Introduction to The Triumphal Entry)

†**3. Woe Unto You ... Hypocrites!** “In these closing chapters of the public ministry of our Lord, you will read about Jesus’ last public confrontation with the scribes, Pharisees, and Herodians; it is the last because the Jewish leaders at this point were determined that Jesus should die for the nation and constantly “they took counsel together for to put him to death.” ([John 11:53](#).) In these chapters you will come to know how they tried to provoke him into an overt act of speech or action by which they might charge him with the capital crime of treason against Roman authority.” ([The Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles](#), see the Introduction to Woe Unto You ... Hypocrites)

†**4. Elder Howard W. Hunter:** “He loves the Lord with all his heart who ... is ready to give up, do, or suffer anything in order to please and glorify him. He loves God with all his soul ... who is ready to give up life for his sake and to be deprived of the comforts of the world to glorify him. He loves God with all his strength who exerts all the powers of his body and soul in the service of God. He loves God with all his mind who applies himself only to know God and his will, who sees God in all things and acknowledges him in all ways.” (in Conference Report, Apr. 1965, 58)

†**5. What can we do to avoid hypocrisy?** “Silently consider these questions: Am I paying tithing, giving to the poor, attending my meetings, and serving others for my own glory or for the glory of God? In all my actions, do I seek to draw closer to my Father in Heaven and Jesus Christ?” ([Lesson Manual](#), 84)

†**6. Marion G. Hanks:** “Vanity it is, I add, and foolishness indeed, to pretend—to say and not to do, to seem and not to be.

“In its worst form, that is hypocrisy. In its best form, I suppose, it might be thought to be pursuing the “as if” principle—that is, to say to oneself, ‘I will behave as if I were honest, decent, moral, courteous, gracious, sensitive and courageous; and in so behaving, I will acquire the capacities, make the habits, and become capable of being all those things.’*
*
“I suspect that most of us fall some place in between. We do not savor, and in fact sicken at, the thought that we are hypocrites, and yet we do so much to be seen of men. We sometimes say that which will tickle the ears of men. We pretend, knowing that in our own quiet places—our closets or, where the place, our minds—we are not what we seem.” (“[Be and Not Seem](#),” *BYU Speeches*, Jan 23, 1979. Elder Hanks tells some [marvelous stories](#) in this talk; especially the story about a Mormon military family’s uplifting effect on their colleagues.)

*[Note: This may be an example of President McKay’s quote: “What e’re thou art, Act well thy part.”]

†**7. Mark E. Peterson:** “It is living lie upon lie that makes a man a hypocrite.

...
“It is the lie of the hypocrite who berates his wife and belittles his children and is a beast in the home that persuades him to assume a pious role on Sunday and sing in the choir and partake of the sacred emblems of the Lord’s supper.

...
“If we say that we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.”

On the other hand he said:

“If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.” (1 John 1:7-9) (General Conference “[Honesty, a Principle of Salvation](#),” Oct. 1971)

†**8. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin:** “To be without guile is to be free of deceit, cunning, hypocrisy, and dishonesty in thought or action. To beguile is to deceive or lead astray, as Lucifer beguiled Eve in the Garden of Eden. A person without guile is a person of innocence, honest intent, and pure motives, whose life reflects the simple practice of conforming his daily actions to principles of integrity.

“The psalmist wrote, ‘Blessed is the man unto whom the Lord imputeth not iniquity, and in whose spirit there is no guile’ (Ps. 32:2), and then admonished, ‘Keep thy tongue from evil, and thy lips from speaking guile’ (Ps. 34:13). (“[Without Guile](#),” *Ensign*, May 1988)

†9. **“LORD, IS IT I?”**: “It was our beloved Savior’s final night in mortality, the evening before He would offer Himself a ransom for all mankind. As He broke bread with his disciples, He said something that must have filled their hearts with great alarm and deep sadness. “One of you shall betray me,” He told them.

The disciples didn’t question the truth of what He said. Nor did they look around, point to someone else, and ask, “Is it Him?”

Instead, “they were exceeding sorrowful, and began every one of them to say unto him, *Lord, is it I?*” [1]

I wonder what each of us would do if we were asked that question by the Savior. Would we look at those around us and say in our hearts, “He’s probably talking about Brother Johnson. I’ve always wondered about him,” or I’m glad Brother Brown is here. He really needs to hear this message”? Or would we, like those disciples of old, look inward and ask that penetrating question: “Is it I?” (President Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “*Lord, Is It I?*” *Ensign*, November 2014)

†10. **STORY ABOUT CURTIS**: “Some years ago a wonderful young man named Curtis was called to serve a mission. He was the kind of missionary every mission president prays for. He was focused and worked hard. At one point he was assigned a missionary companion who was immature, socially awkward, and not particularly enthusiastic about getting the work done.

“One day, while they were riding their bicycles, Curtis looked back and saw that his companion had inexplicably gotten off his bike and was walking. Silently, Curtis expressed his frustration to God; what a chore it was to be saddled with a companion he had to drag around in order to accomplish anything. Moments later, Curtis had a profound impression, as if God were saying to him, “You know, Curtis, compared to me, the two of you aren’t all that different.” Curtis learned that he needed to be patient with an imperfect companion who nevertheless was trying in his own way.

“My invitation to all of us is to evaluate our lives, repent, and keep on trying. If we don’t try, we’re just latter-day sinners; if we don’t persevere, we’re latter-day quitters; and if we don’t allow others to try, we’re just latter-day hypocrites. [10] As we try, persevere, and help others to do the same, we are true Latter-day Saints. As we change, we will find that God indeed cares a lot more about who we are and about who we are becoming than about who we once were. [11] (“*Latter-day Saints Keep on Trying*,” *Ensign*, May 2015)

†11. **TO CHEAT OR NOT TO CHEAT**: “All evening I thought about my problem. I tried to concentrate on how important it was for me to do well on these tests, but a thought kept nagging at me. For four years I had taken seminary and answered those case studies of how I would react in a situation exactly like this. Was I going to betray my standards after telling my friends what being a Mormon was all about? Was I now going to be a hypocrite? I decided to resist the temptation. I prayed to my Heavenly Father to make me strong and able to stand by my convictions.” (Marcelle Gill, “*Not a Hypocrite or a Hero*,” *Ensign*, Jan. 1989)

†12. **“THE SPIRITUAL HAZARDS OF FAULTFINDING”**: “Carla and Tim moved into a new home about two years ago. Since that time their relationships with their neighbors have deepened and become more rewarding. They’ve noticed, however, that as they become more familiar with their new friends, they also see more of their shortcomings. Apparent flaws in everything from the upkeep of their yards and homes to their child-rearing practices seem more glaring—and more irritating—all the time. They have begun to dwell on their neighbors’ faults in their conversations at the dinner table, and sometimes as they lie in bed at night they find themselves talking about the little things that bothered them that day.

...
“While it’s easy to condemn the hypocrisy of the scribes and Pharisees, we may not be all that different today... Our own imperfections fade from our notice as we watch the sins of others paraded before us. Then, following condemnation of the designated villain, we see no need to work on our own imperfections that seemed to have diminished into insignificance.

“If we ridicule others, content in believing that our sins are hidden from them, we become hypocrites like the scribes and Pharisees, whom Jesus likened to “whited sepulchers, which indeed appear beautiful outward, but are within full of dead men’s bones, and of all uncleanness” (Matt. 23:27).

“Finally, when we criticize and find fault with others, our perception can be distorted because we often see our own weaknesses in others...

“If we project our flaws onto others, perhaps our attitude toward them is a barometer of our own lackluster performance...

...
“Perhaps that is why the Lord abhors hypocrisy. Feelings of self-righteousness and complacency are deceptive, for if we are satisfied that our problems aren’t as serious as someone else’s, we tend to forget that how we stack up against other people is not the criterion for our gaining eternal life.” (Mark D. Chamberlain, “*The Spiritual Hazards of Faultfinding*,” *Ensign*, August 1996)

†13. Don't look for the flaws in others, but rather look for the strengths in others.

For example, looking for the flaws in others is like looking for the flaws in a multi-million dollar Ming dynasty ceramic vase. It's much better to see the beauty of the Ming vase than it is to see its flaws. See [Wikipedia: Chinese ceramics; Ming Dynasty Bowl Sells for \\$18 Million](#) (YouTube 1:22); or "[The \\$36 Million Ming Dynasty-era Bowl](#)," (The Wall Street Journal, April 8, 2014).

Peter F. Drucker, a business management consultant and educator who "has been described as '[the founder of modern management](#).'" Noted that it was the practices of executives that made them effective, not their personalities and he described five key practices that he found in all effective executives. The practice of interest to us, he called, "Making Strength Productive."

His point? Find the strengths of your colleagues and subordinates and work with their strengths.

He wrote: "The effective executive makes strength productive. He knows that one cannot build on weakness. To achieve results, one has to use all the available strengths—the strengths of associates, the strengths of the superior, and one's own strengths. These strengths are the true opportunities. To make strength productive is the unique purpose of organization. It cannot, of course, overcome the weaknesses with which each of us is abundantly endowed. But it can make them irrelevant. Its task is to use the strength of each man as a building block for joint performance." (*The Effective Executive*, 71)

For our purposes we might say: Effective Latter-day Saints don't waste their time finding flaws in other people to criticize. Rather, they find strengths in other people to appreciate or they find ways to help and serve them. This alone helps them be less like the Pharisees and Sadducees.

†14. "[Flirting with Hypocrisy](#)," *Ensign*, June 1986.

Dare we compromise
Good by occasionally
Sewing evil seeds and
Deceivingly believe
Our unkind thoughts
And deeds are secretly
Concealed when so
Shortly in eternity
All unamended wrongs
Will be revealed?

(Carolyn Freebairn)

†15. President Uchtdorf: "Some might say, "I don't think I could live up to your standards."

"All the more reason to come! The Church is designed to nourish the imperfect, the struggling, and the exhausted. It is filled with people who desire with all their heart to keep the commandments, even if they haven't mastered them yet.

"Some might say, "I know a member of your Church who is a hypocrite. I could never join a church that had someone like him as a member."

"If you define hypocrite as someone who fails to live up perfectly to what he or she believes, then we are all hypocrites. None of us is quite as Christlike as we know we should be. But we earnestly desire to overcome our faults and the tendency to sin. With our heart and soul we yearn to become better with the help of the Atonement of Jesus Christ." ("[Come, Join With Us](#)," *Ensign*, Nov. 2013)

†16. Beverly Campbell, "[Challenges of the '80s](#)," *Ensign*, April 1981.

Keynote address of the multi-regional youth conference held in and near Roanoke, Virginia, from August 7 to 10, 1980. See report beginning on page 22

"How many of you have read Dr. Seuss? It seems that one day this interesting man was asked to give a graduation speech. It was a bright, sunny day, and he strolled across the platform and turned to face the audience to deliver the following speech, exactly six lines long:

"This is my speech. Would you like to hear it? It's called 'My Uncle Terwilliger on the Art of Eating Popovers.'

"My uncle ordered popovers from the restaurant bill of fare,

And when they were served, he regarded them with a penetrating stare.

Then he spoke great words of wisdom as he sat down on that chair.

'To eat these things,' said my uncle, 'you must exercise great care.

You must swallow down what's solid, and you must spit out the air.'

"And my concluding comment,' said Dr. Seuss, 'is, if you partake of the world's bill of fare, that's darn good advice to follow. Do a lot of spitting out of hot air, and be careful of what you swallow."

"In a different spirit, but speaking on the same subject and referring to our day, one of our prophets, President Harold B. Lee, said:

"We have some tight places to go before the Lord is through with this church and the world in this

dispensation, which is the last dispensation, which shall usher in the coming of the Lord. The gospel was restored to prepare a people ready to receive him... There will be inroads within the Church. There will be 'Hypocrites, those professing, but secretly are full of dead men's bones.' We will see those who profess membership but secretly are plotting and trying to lead the people not to follow the leadership that the Lord has set up to preside in this church...

"You may not like what comes from the authority of the Church. It may contradict your political views. It may contradict your social views. It may interfere with some of your social life. But if you listen to these things, as if from the mouth of the Lord himself, with patience and faith, the promise is that the gates of hell shall not prevail against you; yea, and the Lord God will disperse the powers of darkness from before you, and cause the heavens to shake for your good, and his name's glory' (D&C 21:6)." (In Conference Report, Oct. 1970, p. 152.)

SCRIPTURES:

[Ether 12:27](#). "And if men come unto me I will show unto them their weakness. I give unto men weakness that they may be humble; and my grace is sufficient for all men that humble themselves before me; for if they humble themselves before me, and have faith in me, then I will make weak things become strong unto them."

[Luke 18:9-14](#). "And he spake this parable unto certain which trusted in themselves that they were righteous, and despised others:

"Two men went up into the temple to pray; the one a Pharisee, and the other a publican.

"The Pharisee stood and prayed thus with himself, God, I thank thee, that I am not as other men are, extortioners, unjust, adulterers, or even as this publican.

"I fast twice in the week, I give tithes of all that I possess.

"And the publican, standing afar off, would not lift up so much as his eyes unto heaven, but smote upon his breast, saying, God be merciful to me a sinner.

"I tell you, this man went down to his house justified rather than the other: for every one that exalteth himself shall be abased; and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted."

[Alma 42:30](#). "O my son, I desire that ye should deny the justice of God no more. Do not endeavor to excuse yourself in the least point because of your sins, by denying the justice of God; but do you let the justice of God, and his mercy and his long-suffering have full sway in your heart; and let it bring you down to the dust in humility."

STORIES:

†17. "[Please Don't Give In](#)," *New Era*, September 1989.

The following is taken from a letter that was sent to the youth of the Church in care of the *New Era*. It is one of several we have received recounting the bitter fruits of substance abuse. The young man who wrote this account was very lucky. He is alive and is finding his way back. Many who pursue his course do not.

"I guess I'd have to say it all started with a bad attitude. When I was about ten years old, I formed the opinion that most people around me weren't as "good" as they seemed to think they were. This feeling of disillusionment grew as I grew.

While there were other youth in the ward, even others my age, who enjoyed church and got something out of it, my friends and I became the group that went through a Sunday School teacher every month and were proud of it.

The members of the ward really didn't approve of our attitude toward them and toward life, and some of them just gave up on us. Some did not. We had a very patient bishop and some great leaders. Most of them, however, we considered hypocrites, and we used their perceived weaknesses as an excuse for our own."

...

... The hardest struggle was inside me, emotionally. My pride was a fierce adversary, and the painful memories sometimes dropped me down into depression.

...

"I have gained a strong testimony of the truth of the gospel. My fellow members are still not perfect, but I finally realized that their imperfection doesn't make the gospel any less true. It just shows that they, too, are human."

†18. Lewis W. Cottle, "[Return of the Prodigal](#)," *Mormon Journal, Ensign*, March 1974.

"Also about this time, I began finding out that some Church members whom I admired greatly were not observing all the standards of the Church. I let myself become their judge, and to me they were hypocrites. I covenanted with myself that if I ever failed to live our standards, rather than be a hypocrite by teaching one thing and doing another, I would stay from the Church. This was another serious error, for this is just what I did and just what the adversary wanted."

†19. Ashley J. Hall, “[Reawakening My Father’s Testimony](#),” *Ensign*, April 1999.

“After listening intently, he told me that some 30 years before he had tried to change his life when he got married. He had succeeded long enough to be sealed in the temple. During this critical period, someone had seriously offended him and he slowly slid back into his old lifestyle. I said, ‘That happened years ago. What does it have to do with today? Why aren’t you active today, Dad?’

“First he looked puzzled, then he talked about the time our home burned down and the bishop came to see the family only once to drop off a case of condensed milk. Next, he told me about the neighbor who had wronged him in some minor business dealings back in the 1950s. Lastly, he spoke of other Church members he felt were hypocrites and said he could never be a hypocrite. After listening to him rationalize for several minutes, I mustered all the courage a 19-year-old son could and looked him directly in the eyes. ‘Dad,’ I said, ‘when you go to the judgment bar, the Savior is not going to ask you what the bishop did or what your neighbors did. He is going to ask you, “Clifford, what have you done?” You won’t be able to blame a bishop, a neighbor, or anyone else. You’ll have to stand before the Savior and answer for yourself.’

“My father turned and walked out of the room without saying a word...”

†20. Heidi Holfeltz Parker, “[Am I What I Appear to Be?](#)” *Ensign*, October 1991.

Are there times when we look at the small weeds in the gardens of other people’s lives but fail to see the tangled mass in our own?

“If you ask me what first pops into my mind when I hear the word *hypocrite*, I’d probably say Frank (the name is changed). Over the years, he has been active in the Church and has served in numerous callings.

“A few years ago, Frank and a friend started a business. It boomed for a time, but when the economy abruptly slowed down, their business fell off. Frank, more perceptive about the company’s impending doom than his partner, took company money and sheltered it in several of his grown children’s bank accounts.

“By the time his partner realized what had happened, they were headed to bankruptcy court. The court determined that the company could file for bankruptcy and no longer be held liable for the debts it had acquired. But in the process, Frank’s partner lost his home. Frank, on the other hand, continued to enjoy his previous lifestyle.

“I’m glad I’m not a hypocrite like Frank,” I sometimes find myself saying. But then I remember that

there have been times that I’ve professed to know God, but have, by my works, denied him. (See Titus 1:16.) I think of the time several years ago when our daughter Heather was born...

“Most of us possess a great ability to discern the acts in other people’s lives that seem hypocritical—while overlooking the inconsistencies in our own. If we concentrate all of our energy and thought on diagnosing others’ inadequacies, we are spared the pain of facing and solving our own problems. But until we honestly confront the inconsistencies in our lives, we cannot make positive changes.

“How can we bring these positive changes about? Perhaps we can start by regularly asking ourselves, “Am I what I profess to be?”

†21. (Name withheld upon request), “[Our Son Returned](#),” *Ensign*, October 1979.

For ten years we prayed for the Lord to bless our straying son.

“Employment was an immediate and high priority, especially for a man who had brought home an empty wallet and a several-thousand-dollar debt. Our good bishop (the same one Jim had rebuffed on the porch) was knowledgeable and alert and might have some leads, but would Jim go this “church-type” route? Jim’s decision to go and see him, at our suggestion, seemed to us second in importance only to his decision to come home, for it put him into the Church network, whereas we had feared he might first seek out former non-LDS or inactive friends. Within twenty-four hours he was in the office of the stake president, who found him a job he started at two days later. To say Jim was impressed would be understating the fact. These two men were not the hypocrites he had classified Mormons as being. They were concerned; they had exerted themselves to help; they really cared.”

†22. Name withheld, “[Why I Didn’t Want to Go to Church ... and Why I Want to Go Now](#),” *Ensign*, June 1998.

“As soon as I was old enough to really begin to understand the gospel, I began to have doubts about it. I often wondered if the gospel was true. But my parents insisted I attend our ward in Germany with them each Sunday, even though I had little desire to be there. I figured I already knew everything that would be said, and I was bored by the routine.

“Not wanting to be there, I was critical of the Church and Church members. I assumed members should always live perfectly what they said in their talks and testimonies. However, I noticed that some parents and children fought,

some people gossiped, and some young people drank and smoked. Blinded by my prejudices, I noticed only those members who didn't rush to help the homeless people who occasionally came into the church building. *Where is that famous charity mentioned in the scriptures?* I wondered. Somehow I missed seeing those who did reach out to help others.

"While I was caught up in this spirit of criticism, my nonmember friends offered me cigarettes and alcohol, and I tried them. But that was not all. After a while, I stayed out at night longer and more often, and I always got home late on weekends. And then, of course, I had no desire to go to church because I was so tired.

"These friends—combined with the hypocrisy I thought I saw in some Church members, the temptations I succumbed to, my boredom in church, my pride, and my disobedience—led me to not want to know anything about the Church."

†23. Deborah Eldredge Milne, "[Nourishing Mind and Soul](#)," *Ensign*, April 1996.

As a college student, I turned my back on the gospel truths of my childhood because I thought I'd found something better.

"After three years of college, I found myself spiritually upside-down. In my literature class, the short stories implied that modern life had no meaning and that people had lost their values. In a cultural-traditions course, the teacher explained that original biblical texts had portrayed Jesus as a violent, rebellious man and that scribes had softened his personality over the centuries. In a teaching-methods course, the professor asked how we would entice our students to read when we became English teachers. You know, the only book some Mormon children have in their homes is a Book of Mormon,' she scoffed. The rest of the class laughed.

...
I didn't recognize how precarious my spiritual position had become, however, until one winter afternoon when I was sitting in the cafeteria with my mother, who was also attending college. Excited by her astronomy class, she leaned forward and told me in rapid, intense tones that galaxies aren't strewn randomly across space but form patterns like fans and rainbows. 'And maybe not a single atom floats in the remote regions between galaxies,' she added. My mother had taught me to read and had encouraged me to build a chemistry lab in my bedroom closet, and now we were sharing our love for learning on the same level.

"But our cozy conversation turned into a confrontation when we started talking about religion. I told my mom that I didn't know whether or not the Church was true and that if I didn't feel differently soon, I might stop attending because I didn't want to be a

hypocrite. I explained to her my suspicion—fueled by my peers at the campus newspaper—that ignorant people leaned on religion simply because they were afraid to die. I told her that I was outraged that my church didn't encourage women to use their talents in a career. I expressed dismay that the Bible contained so many stories that seemed improbable or immoral."